

span a wider spectrum of styles, it is better to choose a reference manager that supports the maximum number of reference styles.

- **Search feature:** Once you have built a vast collection of references, searching across those collections becomes the most time-saving option.

- **PDF annotations:**

Reference managers like Mendeley have built-in PDF annotation features. Zotero has the facility to read the annotations made by other tools. Annotations are handy to make your comments on the PDF, which can be utilised later.

Apart from the above specified list, one must consider other features like browser support, import/export features, collaboration features, etc.

Why Zotero?

From the list of selection factors specified above, it can be inferred that Zotero has many positive points in its favour like being cross-platform, open source, offering smartphone support, collaboration features, etc. Zotero is an open source reference manager that is popularly called a personal research assistant by its users. The initial release of Zotero was in the year 2006 by the Centre for History and New Media at George Mason University, Virginia, USA.

The primary reason for choosing Zotero is its simple and intuitive workflow. It provides five major features under a single umbrella, as shown in Figure 3.

How to use Zotero

Now let us illustrate how to use Zotero with a series of steps. Zotero comes in two basic forms. One is the Zotero standalone version and the other is the Zotero Firefox add-on. The first version was launched as the Firefox add-on. The standalone version, which uses XULRunner, was launched in 2011. You can use either the Firefox add-on or the standalone



Figure 3: Why Zotero?

desktop version. They can be downloaded from the Zotero website <https://www.zotero.org/download/>

Zotero standalone

The Zotero standalone looks like the screenshot shown in Figure 4. It lists all the reference items that you have gathered, under 'My Library' (marked as 1). We can create folders to group the items. The middle section (marked as 2) of the screen displays all the items under the selected folder. The last section (3) shows the fields under the selected item. It allows one to edit the fields as well. Tags and notes can also be added from the respective tabs.

Zotero Firefox add-on

The Zotero Firefox add-on is used for the same purposes as the standalone version with the only difference being that the add-on version requires you to keep Firefox open whenever you want to use Zotero. The Firefox add-on also permits the items in the library to be modified. If you use both the versions in your system, then modifications from any one of them will reflect in the other as well.

Apart from the Firefox add-on, there are connectors available for many other browsers like Google Chrome, Opera, Safari, etc. If you prefer a browser other than Firefox, then a combination of this connector and standalone version is handy.

Adding an item to Zotero

Adding an item to the Zotero library has been made very simple by the automatic content-sensing feature of Zotero. After installing Zotero standalone or the Firefox plugin, if you visit a publisher's site or any indexing site like Google Scholar, you will notice an icon in the address bar. By merely clicking the icon, the item is added to the library, as shown in Figure 5.

Any Web page can be added as an item to the Zotero library, by right-clicking and selecting *Save Zotero Snapshot* from the *Current Page*.

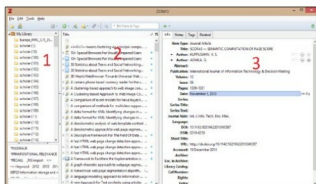


Figure 4: Screenshot of the Zotero standalone version

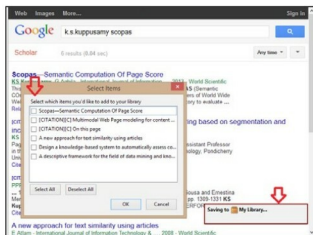


Figure 5: Adding an item to Zotero